

WHO'S DOING WHAT?

● Increased awareness and market potential are driving established pharmaceutical companies to diversify their portfolios

Company/Investor	Target/Business	Year	Deal Value	Details
Mankind Pharma	Bharat Serums and Vaccines Ltd	2024	₹13,630 crore (~\$1.63 billion)	► Strengthened portfolio in gynaecology and reproductive health
Viartis	Women's healthcare business sold to Insud Pharma	2024	Part of a global \$1.2-billion deal	► Viartis divested its oral and injectable contraceptive business to Spain-based Insud Pharma, including manufacturing sites in Sarigam and Ahmedabad, expanding Insud's operational footprint in India
Cipla	Acquired women's health nutraceutical brands from Wanbury	2020	Undisclosed	► Acquired four brands—CPink, CDense, Productiv, and Folinine—addressing anaemia, calcium deficiency, infertility, and pregnancy-related nutrition
BPEA EQT (Private Equity Firm)	Indira IVF	2023	₹9,000 crore (~\$1.1 billion)	► Acquired a 60% stake in Indira IVF, aiming to expand access to IVF services and strengthen technology
Puig (Spanish Beauty and Wellness Group)	Kama Ayurveda	2022	Undisclosed	► Acquired a majority stake in Kama Ayurveda, focusing on skincare, haircare, and women's self-care

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market covers a wide range of products and services, and this broad scope shows the multifaceted nature of women's healthcare needs and the corresponding opportunities for innovation.

This increased awareness and market potential are driving pharmaceutical companies to diversify their portfolios. Kallianpur cites examples such as Cipla's launch of the Evexpert intimate wash and its partnership with Orchid Pharma for urinary tract infection treatments and collaboration with Ferring Pharmaceuticals, and Dr. Reddy's distribution agreement with Novartis India.

He also points to investments by Dr. Reddy's and Torrent Pharmaceuticals in menopause and PCOS therapies. Looking ahead, he sees significant growth potential in the untapped rural market, the increasing adoption of femtech, and more government-backed schemes.

Sales of infertility treatment medicines surged from ₹536.7 crore in FY21 to ₹1,212.1 crore in FY25, marking a 126% increase and a five-year CAGR of 22.6%.

Notably, Mankind Pharma emerged as a leader in this segment. However, a recent stabilisation signifies the dynamic nature

of the market and the importance of continued innovation.

Sheetal Sapale, VP Commercial at Pharmarack, a commerce-to-insights technology company, corroborates the broader drivers of this growth, stating increased female literacy, income, and planned pregnancy trends driving growth in women's health drugs.

As awareness increases and women take to caring for their health, eyes are on the sector to keep innovating, tailoring products just for her. **BT**

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